

The value of slow food isn't just better digestion or better flavour



For most of human history, food simply took time. Bread didn't rise because someone added insyeast. It rose because wild microbes in the air slowly transformed flour and water into something alive. What we now call sourdough was once just... bread.

Fermentation wasn't a trend.
It was **everyday wisdom.**

Across cultures, people relied on time and microbes to make food more nourishing and easier to digest.

In India, batters for idli and dosa rested overnight. Clay jars of kanji slowly fermented in the sun.

In Korea, vegetables transformed into kimchi.

In Europe, grains became long-rising breads.

In many homes around the world, tea quietly turned into kombucha.



No rush.

Just patience.

Today we often speak about fermentation as if it were a modern discovery.

But our ancestors practiced it without the language of probiotics or gut microbiomes. They simply noticed something: Food prepared slowly felt different in the body — lighter, easier, more sustaining.



Somewhere along the way, food stopped asking for our time.

Fermentations that once took days are now often rushed.

Kombucha that once quietly fermented in jars is sometimes carbonated with gas.

Bread that once rose slowly is pushed quickly with commercial yeast.

Food became faster.

But something quieter disappeared with that speed — the patience that traditional food quietly required of us.

Many cultures also had a simple ritual before eating — a pause, a prayer, a moment of gratitude.

It created a moment of presence before nourishment.

Today we rarely pause.

We rush.

Maybe the solution isn't to change everything we eat.

Maybe it's simpler than that.





Every couple of weeks, make one thing that cannot be rushed.
A loaf of bread.
A jar of kanji.
A quiet fermentation waiting patiently in the corner of the kitchen.

Not just for our gut.
But to remember something simple.

The most important ingredient in slow food isn't the microbe.

It's the wait.

What is one food that still asks for your patience?

